current directory by simply using a period (.) instead of the $PWD environment variable. Compose allows for relative paths like this based on where the docker-compose.yml is located—a nice little bonus.

On relaunching our app with this change:

```
$ docker-compose up -d
```

we're now able to follow the typical development flow of editing files locally and immediately seeing the changes simply by reloading the browser.

Rails Server Not Starting?

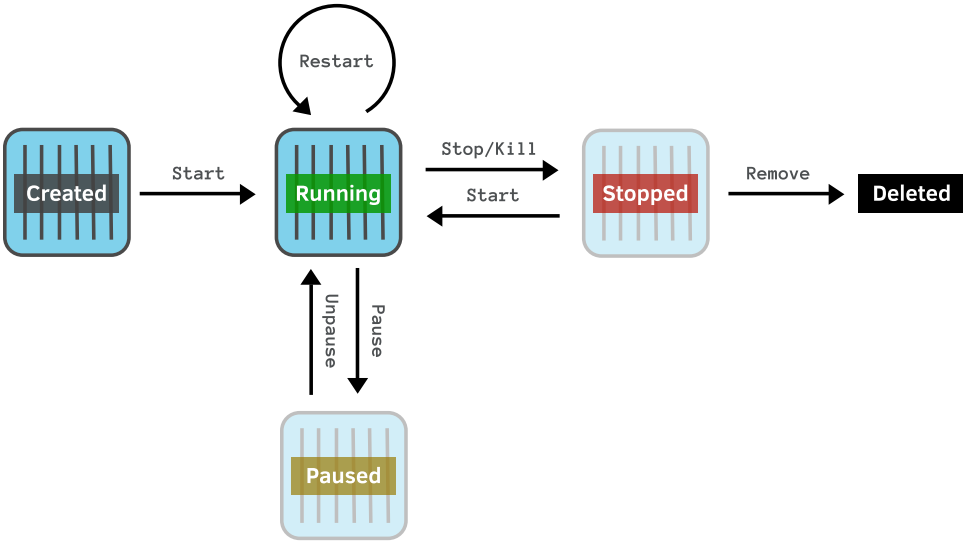


On starting Rails, it's possible you may encounter the same issue mentioned earlier. If Rails thinks the server is already running, you'll need to delete tmp/pids/server.pid on your local machine. We'll see a better way to handle this in Chapter 9.

Starting and Stopping Services

A common thing we'll need to do while developing our application is to stop or start the various services that make it up. In a moment, we'll dive into the fine-grained control Compose gives us to do this. Before we do, though, it's helpful to have in mind the journey that containers go through, from creation until they are no longer needed.

The following figure shows a simplified version of a container's life cycle:



A container comes into existence in the *created* state. It doesn't execute any code; it merely sits around waiting until it's called for. When the container is